Past Simple or Past Continuous?

Use the appropriate form of the verbs in brackets in the following sentences.

1) While we were watching (watch TV) the phone rang (ring).
2) She was reading (read) a newspaper while she was waiting(wait) for the bus.
3) They were dancing (dance) when I arrived (arrive).
4) My roommate got up (get up), took (take) a shower, then left (leave) without saying a word.
5) How fast were you driving (drive) when the accident happened (happen)?
6) They were speaking (speak) about me when I entered(enter) the room.
7) No wonder he can't do the task: he was talking (talk) all the time while the teacher was explaining (explain) it.
8) It was (be) impossible to sleep because the neighbour's dog was barking (bark) for hours last night.
9) We always spent (spend) the summer holidays in Brighton when I was (be) a child.
10) When I met (meet) them, they were walking (walk) hand in hand.

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Write 8 compound sentences (similar to the ones above). Use both the Past Simple and the Past Continuous.

1. While I was studying for my English exam, my friend called me on the phone.
2. I was writing some code on my laptop when the internet connection suddenly stopped.
3. While we were having dinner at home, it started to rain heavily outside.
4. She was walking to the train station when she met her old colleague.
5. While the professor was explaining the new lesson, the students took notes.
6. My brother broke his favourite cup while he was washing the dishes in the kitchen.
7. They were waiting for the bus when they saw a famous actor in the street.
8. I fell asleep on the sofa while I was watching an interesting film on TV.

KEY

1) were watching, rang
2) was reading, was waiting
3) were dancing, arrived
4) got up, took, left
5) were … driving, happened
6) were speaking, entered
7) was talking, was explaining

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8) was, was barking

9) spent, was

10) met, were walking

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